8. Personal hygiene and bathing with little water (English)

Oracle OS guide (WHO, Sphere, Hesperian). Handwashing is the single most important measure.

Handwashing

- Soap and water, scrub **20 seconds** (palms, backs, between fingers, nails, wrists).
- After the toilet, before cooking and eating, after nappies, rubbish, animals, and caring for the sick.
- No running water: build a **tippy-tap** (hanging jug with a small hole, tilted by a stick and string; soap on a string).
- Hand sanitiser with **at least 60% alcohol** when hands are not visibly dirty. No soap: clean ash rubbed and rinsed is better than water alone.

Sponge bath with 2–4 litres

Basin, cloth, soap. Order: **face → neck and arms → torso → legs → feet → genitals last**. Rinse with a wrung cloth, change water if very dirty, dry well between toes and skin folds.

Teeth

Brush twice a day with treated or boiled-and-cooled water.

Menstrual hygiene

Pads, tampons, cup or clean cotton cloths. Wash reusable cloths with soap (cold then hot water) and **dry in the sun**. Boil cups between cycles.

Toilet without water (bucket toilet)

- **Two buckets**: urine (dilute and pour away from wells and streams) and faeces.
- Line with a strong bag; after each use cover with **sawdust, dry soil, ash or lime**; lid on. Tie off half-full bags, store in a closed bin away from the house and water until collection.
- **Outdoor latrine**: at least **30 m** from any well, stream or water source, and downhill of it.
- Don't use a flush toilet without water — it blocks and contaminates.

Laundry and skin

Wash in a basin with a little soap, rinse once, dry in the sun. Clean small wounds with treated water and soap and cover; seek help for spreading redness, pus, fever or red streaks.